

FREE AND REDUCED-PRICE MEAL SERVICES

Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) provides free and reduced-price breakfasts and lunches to students according to the terms of the National School Lunch Program (NSLP), the School Breakfast Program (SBP), and any other special meal/snack programs identified herein to meet the needs of our students.

A. Definitions.

1. Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP). SNAP provides food benefits to lower-income families to supplement their grocery budget and can be used like cash to buy eligible food items from authorized retailers as provided by the Department of Social Services pursuant to subsection D of the Virginia Code [§ 63.2-801](#)

2. First Day Information (FDI). FDI is a valuable resource informing families of the school calendar, school hours, teacher assignments, communication methods, social supports, resources, and FAQs. Additionally, FDI provides a direct link to the [School Nutrition Program website](#), where families can access and complete applications for meal assistance.

3. Community Eligibility Provision (CEP). CEP is defined as a non-pricing meal service option that allows schools to provide free breakfast and lunch to all enrolled students in low-income areas without requiring household applications.

4. Student Rights and Responsibilities Handbook for Families and Student Code of Conduct (SRR). The SRR Handbook summarizes the rights, responsibilities, and expectations adopted by the Loudoun County School Board to ensure and enhance a positive, healthy, and safe teaching and learning environment, free from disruption.

B. Free and Reduced-Price Meal Applications.

1. Applications for free and reduced-price meals will be made available online to families no later than six working days before the first day of school at <https://www.lcps.org/o/lcps/page/free-reduced>.

2. Families may also pick up a paper application at the school's front office starting six working days before the first day of school.

C. Student Eligibility.

1. School officials will determine student eligibility for Free and Reduced-Price Meal Participation based on guidelines established by applicable state and federal laws. Eligible students will be provided nutritionally acceptable meals at a free and/or reduced cost if state and federal resources for school food programs are available. The Superintendent or designee will establish procedures as needed to implement this policy.

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2. The criteria for determining student eligibility and the procedures for accessing free and reduced-price meals will be publicly announced in the LCPS Family Newsletter and posted on the School Nutrition Program website at <https://www.lcps.org/o/lcps/page/free-reduced>, prior to the start of each school year, throughout the school year, and made available to parents/guardians of all LCPS students.

3. The School Board shall ensure that the SNAP information sheet is provided as a part of the FDI to each student enrolled in an elementary or secondary school in the School Division at the beginning of each school year or, in the case of any student who enrolls after the beginning of the school year, as soon as practicable after enrollment.

4. The School Board will ensure that all students enrolled in non-CEP LCPS elementary or secondary schools receive information about the availability of free and reduced-price meal paper applications and the online application process. This information will be provided as a part of the FDI and the SRR Handbook at the start of each school year. For students who enroll after the beginning of the school year, this information will be shared as soon as practicable following their enrollment.

5. Moreover, the School Board shall ensure that at any non-CEP LCPS back-to-school night event to which the parents of enrolled students are invited, any parent in attendance receives prominent notification of and access to, in paper and electronic form, information about application and eligibility for free or reduced-price meals for students and a fillable free or reduced-price meals' application that may be completed and submitted on site.

6. If the School Board collects information to determine eligibility for participation in the SBP or the NSLP, it posts prominently on its website a web-based application for student participation in such a program and provides a paper-based application.

7. Each elementary and secondary school submits each web-based and paper-based free and reduced-price meal application to the School Nutrition Services administrative office for processing to determine eligibility to participate in the SBP or the NSLP. Applications are processed within six working days after the date of receipt of the completed application at the school. While awaiting application approval, charges for meals incurred during the processing period will be reversed upon approval of the application.

8. Students who participate in the free and reduced-price meals programs will not be overtly identified, distinguished, or served differently than other students.

D. Afterschool Meal Program. For any school in the School Division that offers after school educational or enrichment activities and had a student population the previous

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school year where at least 50 percent of the population qualified for free and reduced-price meals, the School Board shall apply to the Virginia Department of Education to participate in the Afterschool Meal Program administered by the U.S. Department of Agriculture Food and Nutrition (FNS) Child and Adult Care Food Program (CACFP). All such approved schools for the Afterschool Meal Program shall serve federally reimbursable meals pursuant to FNS guidelines and state health and safety standards.

Adopted: 05/24/22

Revised: 11/15/22

Current Revision: 02/25/25

Legal Refs: Code of Virginia, 1950, as amended, §§ 22.1-79, [22.1-207.2:2](#), [22.1-207.3](#), [63.2-801](#); [8 VAC 20-740-10](#); [8 VAC 20-740-30](#); [8 VAC 20-740-35](#); [8 VAC 20-740-40](#); [42 U.S.C. §§ 1758](#) and [1773](#); [7 C.F.R. §§ 210.9](#), [220.20](#), [245.5](#), and [245.8](#)